

If by chance you have a secret drawer of unused makeup products yourself, go through it and ruthlessly purge what you don't like or won't ever wear. Then make it a habit to always check that bin before adding a new product to your grocery list. Many times, I've forgotten what I threw in there, and am completely surprised to find unopened products just waiting to be used.

However, if you *do* buy something, and end up not liking it at all, don't hesitate to take it back. I regularly purchase makeup from Target, Ulta, and Mary Kay, and they all have very generous return policies. You can exchange just about anything you've already opened!

2. BUY FROM THE DRUGSTORE

Drugstore prices do not always mean it's a bad product. I have found several inexpensive brands that are preferable to higher quality labels. Plus, you can always find coupons for makeup in the Sunday paper or online to combine with store sales, meaning you almost never have to pay full price.

To avoid purchasing a dud, do a little research online before heading to the store. You can Google "best drugstore concealer" or something similar, and find even more information on a specific product just by adding "review" to the end of the name. Thousands of beauty bloggers and vloggers make their living testing and showcasing makeup products, so one of them is bound to feature what you're looking for.

Another tip: don't be afraid to take a bottle of your current makeup with you when you go shopping. Comparing colors is the best way to make sure you buy the right product the first time around, especially when it comes to foundation, so try to match it as best you can before heading to the checkout line.

READER TIP:

If you have a Dollar General or Big Lots, check there. I have scored big on Olay BB Cream at Big Lots. They have big brand names there for less. Dollar General is hit or miss but great for beauty supplies for